



About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. Scholars may see some variation in songs, topics, and activities from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

M/J Music Theory 1 brings the study of how music works to middle-school depth: a full year in the elements of music and the craft of reading it. The year moves in four big steps: first the parameters of music — rhythm, melody, harmony, tone, and the expressive qualities that make music speak; then the great adventure of learning to read and sing written music, with Mozart, Louis Armstrong, Dave Brubeck, and Beethoven as companions along the way; then music-reading challenges and the instruments of the orchestra; and finally a closing review and a Final Music Review Project that gathers the whole year. Real music is everywhere in the course, from classical to jazz to pop and K-Pop.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 37 WEEKLY MODULES

Quarter	What scholars study, module by module
Q1 · The Parameters of Music	What music is made of: an introduction, then rhythm, melody, harmony, expressive qualities, and tone; music history and appreciation; a quarter review and quiz
Q2 · Learning to Read Music	Beginning to read and sing music; note values and treble-clef reading; composers and styles along the way — Mozart and rhythmic reading, Louis Armstrong and jazz, Dave Brubeck, Beethoven and the symbols of musical expression; pop music; an end-of-semester review with Christmas music
Q3 · Reading Challenges & the Strings	Music-reading review and challenge; memorizing rhythmic notation; a K-Pop reading challenge; marking the beat; practicing note values and beating patterns; instruments of the orchestra — the strings, in three parts
Q4 · Instrument Families & the Finale	The remaining families of the orchestra, including the brass, with music-reading skills growing throughout; a three-part year review; the Final Music Review Project

A TYPICAL WEEK

- ▶ One **weekly module**: a short lesson on the week's concept or composer
- ▶ **Real music to hear** — the course teaches by listening, not just explaining
- ▶ A practice activity, and many weeks a short **quiz or check**
- ▶ **Office hours and live VR experiences** run alongside the modules for scholars who want more

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week is the school's designated planning figure for this course: about 50 minutes a day, Monday through Friday. The weekly module, its listening, and its practice are the core of that time; the Final Music Review Project may run longer.

THE LISTENING LIST

- ▶ **Classical**: Mozart and Beethoven, met as the course learns rhythm and expression
- ▶ **Jazz**: Louis Armstrong and Dave Brubeck, met as music reading grows
- ▶ **Today**: pop music and a K-Pop music-reading challenge
- ▶ **The orchestra**: the string and brass families, instrument by instrument

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ A computer or tablet with **speakers or headphones** — listening is at the heart of every module
- ▶ A singing voice; the course reads music by singing it
- ▶ **VR headset** (optional but encouraged) for the live VR experiences offered alongside the course

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR with a teacher and classmates on the school's weekly schedule.